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ChurchGeniusPro

Complete User Manual

Church Management · Financial Tracking · Member Engagement

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Introduction & Overview

What is ChurchGeniusPro?

ChurchGeniusPro is a comprehensive, web-based church management platform designed to help churches of all sizes efficiently manage their congregation, finances, events, and communications — all in one secure, cloud-hosted application.

The platform is accessible from any modern web browser. No software installation is required. Every user sees only the features relevant to their assigned role, keeping the experience focused.

Core Feature Areas

Member & Family Management

Maintain a complete directory of members organized by family unit. Track demographics, contact information, roles, and member types.

Events & Meetings

Schedule services, special events, and meetings. Send reminders automatically and allow attendees to register online.

Groups

Organize members into ministry groups, committees, or Bible study classes. Send targeted emails to any group instantly.

Financial Management

Record all income (tithes, offerings, donations) and expenses with full audit trail. Define custom funds, purposes, and transaction types.

Accounting Reports

Generate income reports, expense reports, transaction histories, year-end tax summaries, and annual financial reports — all exportable as PDF.

Communications

Send email notifications, manage prayer requests, share daily promise verses, and configure automated reminders.

Public Screens

Push content to lobby or sanctuary display screens directly from the platform.

Administration

Manage church logo, email configuration, member types, and all lookup tables through dedicated settings pages.

i ChurchGeniusPro runs entirely in your web browser. Recommended browsers: Google Chrome (latest), Microsoft Edge, and Mozilla Firefox.

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User Roles & Permissions

What each user can see and do

Every user in ChurchGeniusPro is assigned one of five roles. The role determines which menu sections and dashboard panels are visible. Roles are assigned by a SuperAdmin when creating or editing a user account.

SuperAdmin	Full access to every feature. Sees both the Admin dashboard and the Accountant dashboard. Typically assigned to the senior administrator.
Admin	Manages the congregation: members, families, groups, events, and communications. Does not have access to financial records or accounting reports.
Accountant	Full access to all financial features: income, expenses, reports, fund management, and the accountant dashboard. Does not see congregation administration pages.
Church	Restricted role that only sees the Admin menu section. Intended for church-branch-level administrators.
User	Basic access. Sees only the General section and Reminders. Suitable for general congregation members.

Menu Access by Role

Menu Section	SuperAdmin	Admin	Accountant	Church	User
Admin	■	■	—	■	—
Admin Settings	■	■	—	—	—
Accounting	■	—	■	—	—
Account Settings	■	—	■	—	—
Accounting Reports	■	—	■	—	—
General	■	■	■	—	■
Reminders	■	■	■	—	■

3

Getting Started

Sign up, log in, reset your password

3.1 Signing Up

New churches are registered through a multi-step onboarding flow. An existing SuperAdmin can invite users by sharing a unique invitation link.

- Step 1 — Enter your email: The system sends a 6-digit One-Time Password (OTP) to verify your email address.
- Step 2 — Verify OTP: Enter the code from your email inbox. Codes expire after a few minutes. Request a new code if needed.
- Step 3 — Create account: Set your display name and a strong password to complete registration.

3.2 Logging In

Navigate to the application URL in your browser. The login page appears automatically.

Field	Type	Description
Username	Text	Your registered username or email address.
Password	Password	Your account password. Click the eye (👁️) icon to show or hide it.
Remember Password	Checkbox	Keeps you logged in across browser sessions on this device.

After a successful login you are redirected to the Dashboard (or to the Users page if your role is Church).

& Sessions expire after 30 minutes of inactivity. You will be redirected to the login page automatically. Save your work frequently.

3.3 Forgot Password

Click the Forgot Password? link on the login page. Enter your registered email address and click Send Reset Link. A password-reset link will be emailed to you. The link expires after a short period. Click it, enter a new password, confirm it, and click Reset Password.

4

The Dashboard

Your at-a-glance command center

The Dashboard is the first page you see after logging in. It is divided into sections that vary based on your role. Each section is a card displaying live data from the database.

Sidebar Navigation

The left sidebar contains the full application menu. Click any menu group to expand or collapse its sub-items. Click &0 (top-left) to collapse the sidebar and gain more screen space. The sidebar shows your name and role at the bottom.

Ø=Ü The church logo (top-left of the sidebar) is clickable. It takes you to the Logo management page where you can upload or change the logo.

4.1 Admin / SuperAdmin Dashboard

Users with the Admin, SuperAdmin, or Church role see these dashboard sections:

Stats Overview

A greeting banner with today's date and four headline stat cards: Total Members, Total Families, Events This Month, and Upcoming Meetings.

Church Growth & Calendar

Two side-by-side cards. Left: a line chart of new members added each month for the current year. Right: a mini monthly calendar with event dots; navigate months with < and > arrows.

Events & Distribution

Left: the next scheduled meetings and services. Right: a Member Distribution bar chart showing counts and percentages for Male, Female, Adults, and Children.

4.2 Accountant Dashboard

Users with the Accountant or SuperAdmin role see these financial sections:

Financial Greeting

A time-sensitive greeting with today's financial context. Visible to the Accountant role only.

Net Balance

Cards showing net balance (Income minus Expense) per main income category, plus a summary card with totals.

Recurring Income Ø=Ü (Pinned)

Always visible. Lists income transactions marked as Recurring. Fill in the Date and Ref No, then click Add to

record a new transaction instantly.

Recurring Expense 📌 (Pinned)

Always visible. Same quick-entry workflow for expense templates.

Income & Expense Stats

Two donut charts: left shows income by sub-category for the current year; right shows expenses by purpose for the current year. Each slice displays the amount and percentage.

Recent Transactions & Chart

Left: paginated table of the 5 most recent transactions (use < Prev / Next >). Right: bar chart of monthly income vs. expense — hover over a bar to see the exact amount.

4.3 Customizing the Dashboard

Click the ⚙️ Customize button (top-right of the dashboard) to open the Customize panel.

- Toggle sections on or off with the eye icon.
- Drag sections up or down to change their order.
- Sections marked with 📌 are pinned and cannot be hidden.
- Click ⏮️ Reset to Default to restore the original layout.

⚠️ Dashboard preferences are saved automatically and synced to the server, so your layout persists after logging out or switching devices.

5

Member & Family Management

Building and maintaining your congregation directory

ChurchGeniusPro organizes the congregation around Family units. Each family has one primary member (Head of Household) and any number of additional members. Individual members can also be viewed and searched independently on the Members page.

5.1 Viewing Families

Navigate to Admin > Family. The page displays all active families in a sortable table.

Column	Description
Photo	Thumbnail photo of the primary member (if uploaded).
Primary	Full name of the head-of-household member. Click the "!" arrow in the column header to sort alphabetically.
Members	Total count of members in the family unit.
Status	Active / Inactive badge.
Actions	Edit, View Members, and Delete buttons.

Click a family row to expand a detail panel listing all members with phone, email, member type, and role.

5.2 Adding / Editing a Member

Click Add Family or the Edit button on an existing family to open the form.

Field	Type	Description
First Name	Text	Required. Member's first/given name.
Last Name	Text	Required. Family surname.
Middle Name	Text	Optional middle name.
Gender	Select	Male or Female.
Role	Select	Head of Household, Spouse, Child, Son, Daughter, etc.
Member Type	Select	Classification defined in Admin Settings > Member Type.
Phone	Text	Primary contact phone number.
Email	Text	Email address.
Address	Text	Street address, city, state, ZIP, country.
Birthday	Date	Day, month, and optional year.
Anniversary	Date	Wedding anniversary day and month.
Photo	Upload	Profile photo (JPEG/PNG).
Inactive	Toggle	Mark as inactive without deleting.
Include in Contributions	Toggle	Controls whether the member appears in contribution reports.

5.3 Membership Requests

If your church uses the public-facing Membership Form, prospective members can submit their information online. Navigate to Admin > Membership Requests to review pending applications. Click Approve (which creates a member record automatically) or Reject each request.

6.1 Creating Events

Navigate to General > Event. Events are church activities open to the congregation (concerts, outreaches, baptisms, etc.).

Field	Type	Description
Event Title	Text	Required. Descriptive name of the event.
Category	Select	Meeting/event type (configured in Admin Settings > Category).
Date	Date	The date the event takes place.
Start / End Time	Time	Optional start and end times (24-hour format).
Location / City	Text	Venue or city where the event is held.
Description	Text	Optional additional details or notes.

' Saved events automatically appear on the Event Calendar and in the Upcoming Events list on the Admin dashboard.

6.2 Event Calendar

Navigate to General > Event Calendar for a full-page calendar view of all scheduled events. Days with events display a colored dot. Click a day to see that date's events. A mini version of this calendar also appears on the Admin dashboard.

6.3 Meetings

Navigate to General > Meetings for recurring services and structured meetings (Sunday Service, Bible Study, Prayer Meeting, etc.).

Field	Type	Description
Title	Text	Name of the meeting.
Meeting Type	Select	Preset type defined in Admin Settings > Category.
Date	Date	Meeting date.
Time	Time	Start time of the meeting.
End Time	Time	Optional end time.
Location	Text	Venue or room.
Notes	Text	Optional meeting notes or agenda summary.



Groups & Communications

Ministry groups, email, and prayer

7.1 Groups

Navigate to Admin › Groups to create and manage ministry groups (e.g., Choir, Youth Ministry, Deacons, Ushers). Each group has a name, description, and a list of members.

- Click Add Group to create a new group.
- Use the Add Members button to search and add congregation members to a group.
- Click Remove next to a member to remove them from the group.

7.2 Sending Email Notifications

Navigate to General › Email to compose and send emails to selected groups or individuals. Before sending, ensure your SMTP settings are configured in Admin Settings › Email Settings.

Field	Type	Description
Recipients	Select	Choose one or more groups, or select individual members.
Subject	Text	Email subject line.
Message	Textarea	Body of the email.
Attachments	Upload	Optional file attachments.

& Emails are sent via the SMTP server configured in Email Settings. Test your settings before sending bulk communications.

7.3 Prayer Requests

Navigate to General › Prayer Requests. Members can submit prayer requests grouped into Sections (e.g., Personal, Family, Healing). Administrators can send a notification email to the prayer team when a new request is received.

8.1 Recording Income

Navigate to Accounting > Income. This page is the primary entry point for all money received by the church — tithes, offerings, special donations, and any other income.

Understanding Funds (Main Category / Sub-Source)

Every income transaction is assigned to a Fund with two levels: a Main Category (e.g., "Tithes & Offerings") and a Sub-Source (e.g., "Sunday Morning Tithe"). The Sub-Source is selected in the form; the Main Category is shown automatically. Configure funds in Account Settings > Fund.

Income Form Fields

Field	Type	Description
Contributor	Search	Type a member name to search. Leave blank for anonymous / general.
Fund	Select	Required. Choose the Sub-Source. Displayed as "Main / Sub".
Date	Date	Required. Defaults to today's date.
Method	Select	Required. Payment method (Cash, Cheque, Online, etc.).
Ref No	Text	Optional cheque or reference number (max 6 characters).
Notes	Text	Optional short note (max 15 characters).
Amount	Number	Required. Dollar amount (e.g., 100.00).
Recurring	Checkbox	Mark as a recurring/starred template (see section 8.2).

Saving and Editing

Click Save Income to record the transaction. It immediately appears in the Recent Transactions table. To edit a record, click Edit in the table — the form re-opens pre-filled. Click ' Clear to reset the form without saving. Click Load More !" to load additional rows in batches of 10.

' When you select a Contributor who has a previous transaction, the Fund, Method, Ref No, Amount, and Note fields auto-fill from their most recent record. Adjust as needed before saving.

8.2 Recurring (Starred) Transactions

The Recurring checkbox marks a transaction as a template. Recurring transactions appear in the Recurring Income panel on the Accountant/SuperAdmin dashboard, enabling fast re-entry.

Using Recurring Income from the Dashboard

- Step 1: Open the Dashboard and scroll to the Recurring Income panel.
- Step 2: Each row shows a starred template with its fund, method, amount, and note.
- Step 3: Verify or update the Date and Ref No fields for this entry.
- Step 4: The Amount and Note fields are pre-filled from the template — edit if needed.
- Step 5: Click ' Add to record the transaction instantly.
- Step 6: A success message confirms the entry. Fields reset to template defaults, ready for the next.

Ø=Ü To remove a transaction from the Recurring panel, go to the Income page, click Edit, uncheck the Recurring checkbox, and save.

9.1 Recording Expenses

Navigate to Accounting > Expense to record all money paid out by the church — utilities, salaries, building costs, supplies, and any other expenditure.

Understanding Purposes

Every expense is assigned a Purpose — the reason for the spending (e.g., "Electricity Bill", "Pastoral Salary", "Sound Equipment Repair"). Purposes are configured in Account Settings > Purpose. The expense is also linked to a Fund (the account being debited).

Expense Form Fields

Field	Type	Description
Expense (Purpose)	Search	Required. Type to search for the expense purpose.
Fund	Select	Required. Main source/fund being debited.
Date	Date	Required. Defaults to today's date.
Method	Select	Required. Payment method.
Ref No	Text	Optional reference or cheque number (max 6 characters).
Notes	Text	Optional short note (max 15 characters).
Amount	Number	Required. Dollar amount.
Recurring	Checkbox	Mark as a recurring/starred expense template.

Click Save Expense to record. Click Load More !" to load additional rows in the table.

9.2 Recurring Expenses

Checking the Recurring box marks an expense as a template. These templates appear in the Recurring Expense panel on the dashboard, allowing common periodic expenses (rent, utilities, payroll) to be recorded quickly. The workflow is identical to recurring income (see section 8.2).

All accounting reports are accessible under Accounting Reports in the sidebar, available to Accountant and SuperAdmin roles. Every report can be exported to PDF using the Download PDF button.

10.1 Income Report

Provides a detailed breakdown of income by member and sub-source for any custom date range.

Filters

- Start Date / End Date — or choose a quick period (Last 1–5 months).
- Member — filter to one or more specific contributors.
- Sub-Category — filter to one or more income sub-sources.

Report Structure

- Members are listed as group headers (blue background).
- Each sub-source contributed to is shown as an indented row with the amount.
- A Member Total row appears when a member contributed to 2 or more sub-sources.
- A Sub-Category Totals section sums each source across all members.
- A Grand Total row appears at the bottom.

10.2 Expense Report

Shows all expenses for a selected date range, grouped by Main Category with each individual expense entry (Purpose / Date / Amount / Method / Ref #) listed beneath.

- Optional Purpose filter — limit the report to a specific expense purpose.
- Category Total rows summarize spending per fund.
- A Grand Total appears at the bottom.

10.3 Date Range Transactions

A combined ledger showing both income and expense transactions for a selected date range, sorted chronologically. Useful for bank reconciliation and auditing. Columns: Date, Type (Income/Expense), Description, Method, Ref #, Amount.

10.4 Year-End Tax Report

Generates an annual giving summary per contributor, formatted for tax receipt purposes. Select the year and optionally filter by member. The report lists each contributor's total donations broken down by fund sub-source. Share this with contributors for their annual tax filing.

10.5 Financial Report

An annual summary report covering the full financial year in two sections:

- Income Section — organized by Main Category. Each category shows its Sub-Sources with individual totals and a Category Total row. A Grand Total Income row closes the section.
- Expense Section — organized by Main Category. Each category shows its Purposes with individual totals and a Category Total row. A Grand Total Expenses row closes the section.
- Net Balance Box — displays Income minus Expenses in large type, color-coded green (surplus) or red (deficit).

' The Financial Report PDF is suitable for presenting to the church board or congregation at an Annual General Meeting.

11.1 Fund Management

Location: Account Settings > Fund

Funds represent the income accounts of the church. Each fund has a Main Source (e.g., "Tithes & Offerings") and one or more Sub-Sources (e.g., "Sunday Tithe", "Wednesday Offering"). Sub-Sources appear in the Income form's Fund dropdown. Add, edit, or deactivate funds here.

11.2 Purpose Management

Location: Account Settings > Purpose

Purposes describe what expenses are for (e.g., "Staff Salaries", "Building Maintenance", "Office Supplies"). They appear in the Expense form and in expense reports. Add new purposes as your church's spending categories grow.

11.3 Transaction Types

Location: Account Settings > Transaction Type

Transaction types define payment methods (Cash, Cheque, Bank Transfer, Online). These appear in the Method dropdown on both the Income and Expense forms.

11.4 Member Types

Location: Admin Settings > Member Type

Member types classify congregation members (Regular Member, Associate Member, Visitor). Used for filtering and reporting across the system.

11.5 Church Logo

Location: Admin Settings > Logo

Upload your church logo (PNG or JPG, max 5 MB). The logo appears in the top-left of the sidebar and in PDF report headers. Click the logo in the sidebar at any time to return to this page. You can delete the current logo and upload a new one.

11.6 Email Settings

Location: Admin Settings > Email Settings

Configure the outgoing email (SMTP) server used for notifications and reminders. Required fields: SMTP Host, Port, Username, Password, and From Address. Click Send Test Email after saving to verify the configuration is working.

11.7 Files & Notes

Location: Admin > Files & Notes

Upload documents, spreadsheets, images, or any file for central storage and access. The Notes sub-section provides a simple text area for storing church policies or announcements accessible to administrators.

ChurchGeniusPro can automatically send email reminders to congregation members. The Reminders menu contains four types:

Event Reminders

Location: Reminders > Event Reminders

Send a reminder email to registered attendees or all members a set number of days before a specific event. Configure the event, days-before count, and recipient group.

Meeting Reminders

Location: Reminders > Meeting Reminders

Similar to event reminders but linked to scheduled meetings. Useful for weekly service reminders sent Friday or Saturday.

Auto Reminders

Location: Reminders > Auto Reminders

Rule-based reminders triggered automatically by the system — for example, birthday greetings, anniversary wishes, or membership renewal notices. Define the trigger type, timing, and email template.

One-Time Reminders

Location: Reminders > One-time Reminders

Schedule a one-off email to be sent at a specific future date and time. Useful for special announcements or seasonal messages.

& All reminders require a working email configuration in Admin Settings > Email Settings. Test your SMTP settings before scheduling reminders.

Navigate to General > Public Screens to manage content displayed on lobby TV screens or sanctuary projectors connected to the system.

You can configure which pages or content blocks cycle on each screen — for example, displaying upcoming events, the daily promise verse, or a welcome message. Each screen configuration has a name and a list of content pages in rotation order.

i The display device must be pointed to the public screen URL provided in the application. Screens refresh automatically at the configured interval.

Q: I cannot log in. What should I do?

A: Check that Caps Lock is off. If you have forgotten your password, use the Forgot Password? link on the login page. If the issue persists, contact your SuperAdmin to reset your account.

Q: How do I change my password?

A: Use the Forgot Password flow from the login page. Enter your registered email and follow the link in the reset email.

Q: Why can't I see the Accounting menu?

A: The Accounting section is only visible to users with the Accountant or SuperAdmin role. Ask your SuperAdmin to adjust your role if needed.

Q: How do I undo a deleted transaction?

A: Deleted records are soft-deleted and not permanently removed immediately. Contact your system administrator to restore a recently deleted record.

Q: Can I import members from a spreadsheet?

A: Bulk member import is available via database-level CSV import. Contact your system administrator to perform a bulk import using the `psql \copy` command.

Q: How do I add a new fund sub-source?

A: Go to Account Settings > Fund. Expand the Main Source you want to add under, then click Add Sub-Source and provide a name.

Q: Why is a member not appearing in the Income Contributor dropdown?

A: The member may be marked as Inactive, or the Include in Contributions flag may be unchecked on their profile. Edit the member in Admin > Family and correct the flags.

Q: How do I export a report to PDF?

A: On any report page, click the Download PDF button (green). The PDF is generated in your browser and downloaded automatically.

Q: The dashboard sections are in the wrong order. How do I fix it?

A: Click the &™ Customize button on the dashboard, drag sections to the desired order, then close the panel. Changes save automatically.

Q: How do I remove a recurring transaction from the dashboard?

A: Go to the Income (or Expense) page, find the transaction in the Recent Transactions table, click Edit, uncheck the Recurring checkbox, and click Save.
